



NEWFOUNDLAND AND LABRADOR STUTTERING ASSOCIATION

Advocacy and Support for People Who Stutter

A Message from the Chair



Greg O'Grady,
Chair, NLSA

We turn 7 this week!

On November 26, 2018 a group of concerned individuals attended a community meeting to discuss access gaps and barriers in services, supports and treatment for a marginalized, underserved and forgotten community, the Newfoundland and Labrador stuttering community. During this meeting the roots of the NLSA were established. The NLSA was approved as a Not-For Profit Association in March of 2019 and received official Canada Revenue Agency Charitable status in August of 2019. The NLSA has and continues to accomplish a lot of community outreach research projects and initiatives since our November 26, 2018 community meeting. The NLSA is making a difference, helping people who stutter become more visible and to finally 'Find Our Voice' by increasing awareness, education, understanding and acceptance of stuttering in our province.

Get Involved

From events and research to advocacy and outreach, the NLSA thrives on community involvement. If you'd like to volunteer, partner, or simply learn more, get in touch. There's always room for another voice at the table.

Email: info@nlstuttering.ca Website: www.nlstuttering.ca

Building Accessibility Across NL



A new, province-wide initiative is being led by the NLSA to better understand and improve communication access for people who stutter and others with communication differences across Newfoundland and Labrador. Through surveys, interviews, community visits, and partnerships with educators, health professionals, families, and local organizations, we're mapping the real experiences of navigating services in our province. The goal is simple but ambitious: to build a more accessible NL where every voice is welcomed, supported, and heard.

The project is now well underway, with survey design finalized and ethics submissions progressing through Memorial University, NL Health Services, and NL Schools. We've hired six new research assistants to support community outreach, data collection, and regional engagement. Recruitment materials are being prepared for launch, and early partnerships with educators, SLPs, social workers, and community groups are taking shape. Our next steps include scheduling field visits to Gander, Corner Brook, and Labrador to begin building regional accessibility hubs.

New Collaborators

The NLSA continues to develop partnerships with organizations across the province. They have agreed to work with, support, provide input and promote our Accessibility project.

Join us in welcoming:

- Association of Early Childhood Educators NL (AECENL) - Skye Taylor, Executive Director
- NL Teachers Association - Dale Lambe, President and Ian Crewe, Executive Director
- NL Public Libraries - Fred Whitmarsh, Director of Library Operations

Bursaries

TIME IS RUNNING OUT...

SIX \$1,000 BURSARIES AVAILABLE

Bursary applications are to be returned by Midnight on Friday November 28. Applicants have one more week to apply for a bursary. To request a Bursary Application Email info@nlstuttering.ca



International Stuttering Awareness Day, Highlights from Mount Pearl, NL



Join us for the NLSA *Kitchen Party*, our warm, welcoming space for people who stutter and allies to connect, share stories, and support one another. You can drop in online from anywhere in the world or join us in person at the public library in Mount Pearl, NL. Whether you're new to the community or a familiar face, there's always a place at the table waiting for you.

Time: Nov 26, 2025 06:30 PM Newfoundland and Labrador. Join Zoom Meeting

<https://us06web.zoom.us/j/86474919351?pwd=CWxNKN2iReyEgmud1hT2lg5zYi7aWx.1>

Greg O'Grady representing NLSA at the City of Mount Pearl Council meeting receiving the City of Mount Pearl Proclamation and speaking to the significance of ISAD day. The City of Mount Pearl Council members proudly wear the specially designed NLSA ISAD name badges by Becky Pendergast, Printing Manager of The HUB. Becky has been an NLSA Ally and has been providing exceptional printing services for NLSA since its inception. For printing needs, Becky can be reached at: becky@thehubstjohns.com

Following the ISAD Protocol presentation at the City of Mount Pearl Council meeting, NLSA received an unexpected Bursary and ISAD recognition in the NL Shoreline Newspaper.

To help Celebrate ISAD NLSA presented its Inaugural Storytime for children at the City of Mount Pearl Library.



As part of National Stuttering Awareness Week, our very own Robert O'Brien, Member of the NLSA Board of Directors and author shared an inspirational video message about his lived experience as a PWS during Stuttering Awareness Week.

Check out his message link:

<https://fb.watch/CYXyKyb3uC/?fs=e>

CSA 2026



We are thrilled to be working with the The Canadian Stuttering Association (CSA) to bring next year's annual conference to Newfoundland and Labrador! Both the CSA and NLSA are not-for-profit charities with small budgets (run by volunteers with no paid staff). Our missions are geared to advocate for people who stutter, to ensure that every voice is heard, and to help persons who stutter live as effectively as possible with their stutter and to achieve their full personal and professional potential. The CSA annual conferences change lives as some attendees may be meeting other people who stutter for the first time! Many find that they have a voice at these conferences and it brings them courage and confidence to speak openly and with greater ease, even after the conference. We look forward to welcoming everyone to St. John's in 2026! Stay tuned for updates.

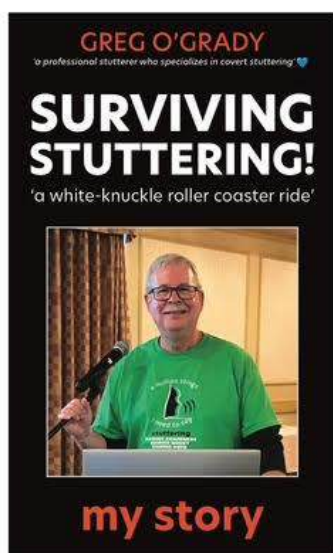
Board Members Spotlight



Dr. Gerald A. Maguire

From: <https://stutteringresearch.org/> Gerald A. Maguire, MD (and NLSA board member) served as first author of the poster presentation for the Orpheus study at the CNS Summit in Boston earlier in November. The trial, sponsored by Noema Pharma (noemapharma.com), evaluated the investigational medication gemlapodect, a PDE10A inhibitor that may modulate dopamine signaling in the brain's striatal regions, in adults with Childhood-Onset Fluency Disorder (Stuttering). The medication was generally well tolerated with mild to moderate side effects of sedation, akathisia and dystonia, with no weight gain observed (unlike dopamine-blocking drugs previously studied in stuttering). Although gemlapodect remains investigational and further research is needed, this work marks a promising step forward in stuttering treatment.

MY BIRTHDAY BOOK LAUNCH November 22, 2025



Available on Amazon Books Canada

MY BIRTHDAY BOOK LAUNCH

November 22, 2025

GREG O'GRADY

My story is a story for all of us! No one makes it through life without encountering unforeseen obstacles. No one makes it through life without being unscathed emotionally, psychologically, physically and spiritually.

My '*BIRTHDAY WISH*' is that by sharing my story if readers who are grappling with their own challenges find in my story inspiration, hope and solace, and through their individual journeys will recognize and accept their lives as accomplishments and understand that '*I AM ENOUGH*' then I have helped.

Volunteer Spotlight



María de los Ángeles Rodríguez, is a Speech-Language Pathologist from Chile: I work with children and young people who have speech and communication difficulties, using playful strategies to make learning fun and meaningful. What motivates me the most is seeing their progress and how they gain confidence when expressing themselves. I collaborate with families and their environment to achieve meaningful results, as I am passionate about supporting these processes and contributing to each patient's well-being.

I am joining this volunteer program with great motivation and I am very grateful for the opportunity to be part of this team. I truly believe that small steps can lead to big changes. I'm very happy to contribute to my profession and to learn from all of you.

Poster Project



The NLSA is moving forward with Phase 2 of the *Open Educational Resource on Stuttering Poster Project*. Phase 1 produced bilingual (English/French) posters for schools across Newfoundland and Labrador, sharing messages such as:

- “Sometimes I Stutter.”
- “Maybe They Stutter.”
- “We Will Wait. We Will Listen.”

They have been warmly received by schools, SLPs, and community partners across the province. Phase 2 expands accessibility by translating posters into Ukrainian, Persian, Farsi, and Yiddish, with additional versions planned in Arabic, Spanish, and other languages. A new draft “Child’s Poster” has



been completed. These updates will ensure every student, educator, and family can access resources that reflect the diversity of our province.

CSA 2025 Report by Ryan Cowley

Key Note Speaker



The 2025 Canadian Stuttering Association Conference was a raving success. Held in beautiful Kingston, Ontario, the conference had a bit of everything, and I was beyond honored to kick things off with my keynote speech on Saturday morning. In my keynote, I discussed my life as a Person Who Stutters from the highs to the lows of dealing with a stutter. Yet while I am confident of the success of my speech, I guarantee that the conference would not have been a successful one without the many who made said success possible. From Dr. Gerald Maguire and fellow keynoter Dr. Luc de Nil to Daniele Rossi and Sam Dunsiger to Mary Wood and Tom Scharstein, the 2025 CSA Conference was one for the ages. That goes especially for the youth camp aspect of the conference, made possible by, among others, the CSA's volunteer coordinator, Rhea Balla. Additionally, a rousing ovation is deserved for the entire CSA Board of Directors and the D'Agostino family, which includes CSA Coordinator, the incomparable Eeva Stierwalt. Weeks and months of planning and hard work made the Kingston conference what it was -- much like the previous conferences in years past. This is one weekend I will never forget, and I have so many to thank for that.

Thank You

We're grateful to all our members, partners, and supporters who make this work possible. Together, we're building a Newfoundland and Labrador where every voice - fluent or not - is valued, heard, and celebrated.